CHECKLIST · BEFORE YOU SHARE

# Dashboard design checklist

A dashboard works when each reader can answer their own question without help. Use this before you share one.

DASHBOARD | AUDIENCE | REVIEWED ON

## 01 Audience and purpose

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | I can name who reads this and the decision it supports | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Each page answers one main question | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | The most important number is top left | Yes No N/A |

## 02 Layout

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | No more than 4 to 6 visuals per page | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Filters are in the same place on every page | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Titles say what the chart shows, for example "Penta 3 coverage by month" | Yes No N/A |

## 03 Charts

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Bars for comparing, lines for trends over time | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Bar charts start at zero | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | No 3D charts and no more than one pie chart per page | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Colour is used to highlight, not to decorate | Yes No N/A |

## 04 Numbers

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Units are shown: %, doses, facilities | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Totals match the source data exactly | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Targets or last period are shown for context | Yes No N/A |

## 05 Trust

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | The data source and last refresh date are on the page | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | Definitions are one click away | Yes No N/A |
| ☐ | A colleague checked three numbers against the raw data | Yes No N/A |

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| 06 Access | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Text is readable on a laptop and a projector | Yes | No | N/A |
| ☐ | Works with colour blindness: do not rely on red versus green alone | Yes | No | N/A |
| ☐ | Only people who should see the data can open it | Yes | No | N/A |

Tip. Show the draft to one real reader and watch them use it for two minutes without helping. Fix what confuses them.